

I am privileged to have so many excellent colleagues at Columbia Business School, and I especially thank Patrick Bolton, Martin Cherkes, Kent Daniel, John Donaldson, Bob Hodrick, Gur Huberman, Wei Jiang, Lars Lochstoer, Chris Mayer, Andrea Prat, Lynne Sagalyn, Suresh Sundaresan, Paul Tetlock, Neng Wang, and Steve Zeldes for excellent comments and help in honing my analysis—especially with respect to the material outside my primary research focus.

One of the things that inspired me to write this book was the Asset Management class that I teach at Columbia. I am grateful both to Ann Kaplan and to the Program for Financial Studies at Columbia Business School for sponsoring development of the class and, of course, to my students. I especially thank Andrés Ayala, my diligent teaching assistant, for helping me develop and manage the class in the first two years.

The book is full of my case studies, and I thank Columbia CaseWorks and all my collaborators: Sarah Abbott, Jeremy Abrams, Josh Brumberger, David Denison, Elizabeth Gordon, Sterling Gunn, Brian Herscovici, Hilde Hovnanian, Bill Jacques, Ann Kaplan, Kate Permut, Valborg Lie, Gina Raimondo, Don Raymond, Jim Scott, Aslak Skancke, Rona Smith, Elizabeth Unger, and also several of the individuals I've acknowledged before. Thank you to those who also read and commented on the book draft. Jim also co-taught a class on Quantitative Investments with me, and some of the material from that class found its way into this book.

A special thank you to Peter Christoffersen and Barbara Ost diek who adopted the book for their classes before it was even half finished. Their comments on the work in progress were very useful. I am grateful to many others for commenting on the manuscript, spotting errors, and offering helpful suggestions (some of which I ignored—it's not you, it's me): Jonathan Berk, David Chambers, James Choi, Emanuel Derman, Charles Fishkin, Ken Frier, Ken French, Francisco Gomes, Robin Greenwood (what a great suggestion of using Janus as the motivating example of chapter 16!), Henry Hansmann, David Hultstrom, Brant Maller, Olivia Mitchell, Tarun Ramadorai, Josh Rauh, Bill Sharpe, Arnie Wood, Dimitri Vayanos, Luis Viceira, and Lu Zheng. I also thank Cam Harvey and John Cochrane, who identified themselves as reviewers when I proposed the book and whose comments I took into consideration as I wrote it. Thank you, Dan Akst, for reading and commenting on the whole manuscript.

Terry Vaughn had the confidence to welcome me to Oxford University Press (OUP). Thank you to my editor Scott Paris, Cathryn Vaulman, and the rest of the OUP team for shepherding a first-timer through the book publishing process.

Most of all, I am grateful to my family. My wife and children have patiently tolerated their father's preoccupation over the last two years, and I cannot thank them enough. At the heart of this book is the role of bad times in factor investing; my family, by contrast, has brought me incredible joy and represents the greatest possible incarnation of good times.